Integrity State Transition Module (ISTM)

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Independent Methodological Authority

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Governed Space

Integrity State Transitions

Canonical Definition

Integrity State Transition Module (ISTM) defines the governance framework for controlling how integrity moves from one operational state to another. It establishes the transition rules, authorization requirements, validation criteria, and governance controls required to ensure that every integrity state change is legitimate, traceable, and consistently governed throughout the complete lifecycle of a governed entity.

Operational Role

ISTM governs the transition layer of integrity state management by ensuring that integrity state changes occur only through validated governance processes rather than arbitrary or uncontrolled events.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define State Transition Rules

Identify all permitted integrity state transitions and define the governance conditions under which each transition is allowed.

2. Define Transition Requirements

Establish authorization requirements, validation criteria, supporting evidence, approvals, and operational prerequisites required before any integrity state transition may occur.

3. Define Transition Validation Logic

Define how transition requests are verified for legitimacy, completeness, consistency, evidence sufficiency, and governance compliance before execution.

4. Define Governance Response

Establish governance actions for approved transitions, rejected transitions, unauthorized state changes, emergency transitions, rollback procedures, and escalation.

5. Preserve Transition Records

Maintain transition requests, approvals, supporting evidence, state histories, authorization records, timestamps, and audit documentation throughout the complete lifecycle.

Example Use Cases

Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI Governance

Scenario

An autonomous AI system changes from Maintained Integrity to Degraded Integrity after repeated policy violations exceed approved governance thresholds.

Application

ISTM validates that the transition satisfies all governance rules before officially changing the integrity state.

Result

Integrity state changes remain fully governed, authorized, and auditable rather than occurring automatically without governance oversight.

Use Case 2 — Pharmaceutical Manufacturing

Scenario

A production facility changes from Operational Integrity to Suspended Integrity after a failed quality validation.

Application

ISTM governs the transition process by verifying evidence, authorizations, and regulatory requirements before the state change becomes official.

Result

Integrity transitions remain transparent, traceable, and compliant with governance and regulatory obligations.

Canonical Closing Statement

Integrity governance requires controlled evolution of operational conditions. Integrity State Transition Module establishes the canonical framework for governing integrity state changes, ensuring that every transition is authorized, validated, traceable, and consistently managed throughout the complete lifecycle of every governed entity.

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Canonical Source

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